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Victim thought ‘that was my last moment’

Man shot on Memorial Drive recounts ordeal as he begins long path of healing

By Hannah Goeke
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Casimir Bangoura was backing his car out of a parking spot near Memorial Drive early on the afternoon of May 11 when a man suddenly appeared just a few feet from him, pointed an assault-style rifle,

and pulled the trigger. The gun jammed. “I saw him trying to reload or clutch it again,” Bangoura said in an interview Friday. “That’s when I put my car in drive and tried the best I could to get away from him.” He took off as the shooter let off

round after round, the bullets striking Bangoura as he tried to steer out of the parking lot and onto Memorial Drive. He lost control and hit a rock.

Trapped, Bangoura said he froze as the gunman again approached his car window.

“I heard him saying some stuff, but I couldn’t really understand what he was talking about. The only word I remember him saying was,

‘alive,’” he said. “I just looked at my legs and they were bleeding. It looked like I had a balloon in my pants. It was filled with blood. When he came to the driver’s side window, I was just praying and hoping that he doesn’t shoot from that angle, because that would be a straight execution.”

One of two drivers injured in the wild midday shootout on one of the

SHOOTING, Page A10

Big race making little noise in Mass.

Markey, Moulton primary is drawing less attention from voters than expected

By Kelly Garrity
GLOBE STAFF

Inside a modest yellow building that once housed an art museum, Massachusetts’ US Senate primary showed signs of life.

Pop music blared from a second-floor room where a trio of digital-savvy campaign staffers worked to boost Representative Seth Moulton’s online presence in his dark-horse bid to oust Senator Ed Markey. Volunteers and staff clustered around tables making calls to voters as Evie, campaign manager Jeff Phaneuf’s 4-year-old husky-mix, padded from room to room.

Voters are “very enthusiastic,” Patricia Fitzgerald, a 79-year-old volunteer, said inside Moulton’s Salem campaign headquarters. “They’re ready for change.”

Outside Moulton HQ, it was a different story. “I don’t even know who’s running,” said John DiBlasio, 44, of Lynn, as he sat on a bench eating a slice of Hawaiian pizza in downtown Salem, a half-mile from Moulton’s campaign office and just a few hundred feet from the six-term congressman’s official district outpost.

Such is the state of what is (supposedly) Massachusetts’ most high-profile political race.

Much of the campaigning so far this cycle has been focused on winning over the Democratic die-

RACE, Page A7

GOP appears to spurn Trump’s brash ways

After attacks on 2 of their own, senators push back

By Luke Broadwater
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — For much of President Trump’s time in office, Republican lawmakers have had little appetite to stand up to his brand of vindictive politics.

Through revenge primary campaigns, bullying social media posts, and the threat that he can command the GOP base to go after anyone at any time, Trump has brought lawmakers in his party under his control like no president in modern history. A single critical word against Trump or his agenda could result in a full-scale retribution campaign to force a disloyal Republican from office.

But this week, in a rarity in GOP politics, Trump’s taunts, bullying, and threats have backfired, at least for now. Senate Republicans, after the president targeted two of their own, stood up to Trump on two of his biggest priorities: money for his White House ballroom, and a \$1.8 billion fund to reward Trump supporters who claim political persecution by Democrats, such as the rioters who attacked the Capitol on Jan. 6, 2021.

“So the nation’s top law enforcement official is

GOP, Page A6



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Jules Charles (right) and Michael Cordon, seniors at Cristo Rey, arrived at the prom after being outfitted by Giving the Glam.

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

Like many high school seniors, Jailene Acosta spent hours dreaming about her prom, scrolling through glossy Instagram photos of glittery gowns and flashy limos. “I wanted everything to be perfect,” said Acosta, a 18-year-old from Roxbury. “But I knew I couldn’t afford what I saw online.”

Enter the fairy-prom mother, Maristela Rapo.

Over the last decade, Rapo’s charity, Giving the Glam, has helped over a thousand Massachusetts students afford the dance of their dreams. She gives high schoolers free ballgowns and suits expertly fitted by seamstresses; a glam squad for hair, nails, and makeup; and even a ride in a Ferrari with a police escort to the party.

As prices surge on everything from tomatoes to coffee to beef, more parents can’t dish out the \$1,000 it typically costs for a storybook prom. Teens are left scouring for gowns, borrowing outfits from relatives, and embellishing old dresses with tricks from TikTok. But people like Rapo are stepping in to fill an increasing need because they believe every student deserves that fairy tale.

Last week, prom festivities kicked off at midday at Rapo’s sprawling house in Dover, about 15 miles outside Boston. It was the big night for seniors at Cristo Rey, a Catholic high school in Dorchester that serves families



with limited economic means.

In Rapo’s living room, two long tables were covered in an array of high heels, designer clutches, and men’s dress shoes. More tables held a rainbow of nail polish, lipsticks, and enough makeup to fill a stand at a Sephora. One at a time, 45 high school seniors rushed into the

PROMS, Page A10

Adriana Menzueta was thrilled with her dress from Giving the Glam.

Something’s brewing in Boston

City’s newest cafe operators are trying to build a coffee boom

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

Squished between a Dunkin’, a Starbucks, and a Caffè Nero, the bar Merai in Brookline is known for funky cocktails. But on a recent Sunday morning, customers packed inside for pour-over coffee served in stemless glassware.

They were lined up for a high-end pick-me-up from Newbery Street Coffee Roasters, a Thai coffee pop-up that has taken over Merai’s space on weekend mornings for the past year. Its owner, Pack Katisomsakul, sauntered from table to table like a sommelier discussing wine, fielding questions about his 12 roasts.

Katisomsakul’s passion for coffee is fairly new. In 2020, a friend back home in Thailand mailed him a bag of coffee beans. It tasted like cherry juice and pomegranates, and had low acidity, unlike the instant coffee he was used to.

“I never thought coffee could taste like that,” the 35-year-old said.

He’s been trying to convince Boston of the same ever since. Katisomsakul is part of a new generation of immigrant and

CAFES, Page A7



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

After a class at The Handle Bar in Boston, coffee and matcha drinks awaited pickup at Nomu, a pop-up cafe owned by Simon Ngo and Tiffany Zheng.



Making the grayed

Saturday: Cloudy, breezy. High: 60-65. Low: 49-54.

Sunday: Rain, getting steadier. High: 51-56. Low: 48-53.

Sunrise: 5:16 Sunset: 8:07
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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Secretary of State Marco Rubio said that “slight progress” was made during talks with Iran as Pakistan’s army chief traveled to Tehran in a renewed effort to mediate a peace deal. **A2.**

Authorities in northeastern Congo banned wakes and gatherings of more than 50 in an effort to curb a rapidly spreading Ebola outbreak. **A4.**

Lawyers for a Babson College freshman mistakenly deported to Honduras last fall are urging a federal appeals court to reinstate a suit she filed against the government, paving the way for her possible return to the US. **B1.**

Massachusetts employers hired at a rapid clip for the second straight month in April. **D1.**